

Research Interests

Political regimes, authoritarian socialization and education, political attitudes, mixed methods

Education

- 2024 **PhD in Political and Social Sciences**
European University Institute, Florence
[The 2024 Linz Rokkan Prize for the best EUI doctoral thesis in Political Sociology](#)
 Thesis: "The effects of political regimes on school quality and learning outcomes"
 Examining Board: Prof. Juho Härkönen (European University Institute, supervisor),
 Prof. Filip Kostelka (European University Institute, co-supervisor), Prof. Sirianne
 Dahlum (University of Oslo), Prof. Katerina Tertychnaya (University of Oxford)
- 2020 **MRes in Political and Social Sciences**
European University Institute, Florence
- 2019 **MSc in Russian Politics and Society**
King's College London
- 2016-2017 **MSc in Political Science**
European University at Saint Petersburg, Russia
- 2012-2016 **BA in International Relations, Political Science, and Human Rights**
Bard College, USA, and Saint Petersburg State University, Russia. Dual degree.

Academic Positions

- 06/2024 – **Visiting Senior Fellow**
 currently *Freie Universität Berlin*
 Cluster of Excellence „Contestations of the Liberal Script” (SCRIPTS)
- 09/2023 – **Postdoctoral Researcher**
 currently *ERC-funded project "Moving Russia(ns): Intergenerational Transmission of Memories
 Abroad and at Home (MoveMeRU)"*

Other Research and Administrative Experience

- 09/2022 – **Research Assistant**
07/2023 *European University Institute, Department of Political and Social Sciences*
Research and administrative assistance to the head of SPS department, Prof. Elias Dinas
- 11/2020 – **Academic Service Assistant**
01/2022 *European University Institute, Department of Political and Social Sciences*
Data collection, archiving, and data digitalization
- 09/2017 – **Junior Researcher**
08/2019 *European University at Saint Petersburg, Russia*
Analysis of voting behavior in Russia in a project led by Dr. Margarita Zavadskaya

Publications and Working Papers

- Kostelka F., Alberdi M., Bradley M., Fiselier T., Jabbour A., Mansour N., Minaeva E., Porciuleanu S., **Rafailova D.** 2026. 'Mass Attitudes towards Russia's Aggression against Ukraine: Tentative Support for Top-Down Opinion Formation'. Forthcoming in *European Journal of Political Research*.
- **Rafailova D.** [Title redacted for peer review]. Under R&R at *Political Studies*.
- Krawatzek F., Matevosyan H., **Rafailova D.** [Title redacted for peer review]. Under R&R at the *European Political Science Review*.
- **Rafailova D.** 'Preferences for Democracy among Russian Immigrants: Intergenerational Focus Group Evidence in Canada.' *Draft available upon request*.
- **Rafailova, D.** 'Negotiating Support for Putin: Perspectives and Strategies of Immigrant Families in Germany, Estonia, and Canada.' *Manuscript under preparation*.
- Nalla, M.K., Gurinskaya, A., and **Rafailova D.** 2017. 'Youth Perceptions of Private Security Guard Industry in Russia', *Journal of Applied Security Research*, 12:4, pp. 543-556.

Invited Talks

- Dec 2025 [Politics of Russia and Eurasia Seminar Series \(PRESS\)](#)
Dec 2024 [Seminar Series in Social and Political Science](#), Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin, Italy
July 2024 Colloquium on Eastern European research, Humboldt University, Germany

Conferences

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| - European Political Science Society (EPSS) Conference | June 2026 |
| - American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting | 2025 |

- The Future of Democracy? 1st Annual Interdisciplinary WZB Conference, Berlin 2025
- Association for Slavic, East European, and Eurasian Studies (ASEEES) Annual Convention, USA 2024, 2025
- Aleksanteri Conference "Resisting Authoritarianism in Eurasia", Helsinki, Finland 2024
- European Political Science Association (EPSA) Annual Conference 2022, 2024
- Population Association of America (PAA) Annual Meeting 2022

Public Outreach and Engagement

- Panelist**, "Political Representation in Exile: The Legitimacy and Influence of Democratic Forces Abroad," The Yuri M. Schmidt International Human Rights Conference, Berlin (forthcoming) 2026
- Panelist**, "Practicing Democracy Under Pressure: Gagarin Center Alumni in Civil Society, Journalism, and Human Rights," Humboldt–Gagarin Conference on Contemporary Threats to Academic Freedom and Democracy, Berlin 2026
- Publication**, "[What is driving Europe's pro-Russian supporters and their stance on the Russo-Ukrainian conflict?](#)", *The Conversation*, Based on joint research by Kostelka et al. 2026

Grants and Awards

The 2024 Linz Rokkan Prize for the best EUI doctoral thesis in Political Sociology, EUI
EUI Wider European Doctorate grant, four-year stipend for conducting a PhD at the European University Institute (2019-2023), European University at Saint Petersburg

Tools and Software

Stata (advanced), R (basic), MAXQDA (basic), LaTeX (advanced)

Methodological Training

Quantitative Methods, EUI SPS, 2019
 Qualitative Methods, EUI SPS, 2020
 Field experiments, EUI SPS, 2021
 List experiments, survey experiments and conjoints, EUI SPS, 2021
 Panel data, EUI SPS, 2020
 Advanced STATA coding, EUI SPS, 2021
 Data Management in STATA, EUI SPS, 2019
 Practicum in Reproducible Research Methods, EUI SPS 2020

Languages

English (fluent), Russian (native), Italian (A2), German (A1)